

CASE FILE: Operation Stolen Legacy

It was supposed to be the proudest moment in the history of CODES.

After months of preparation, the annual CODES Innovation Summit was finally underway. Hundreds of students, alumni, judges, sponsors, volunteers, and guests filled the venue, eagerly waiting for the grand finale. At the center of the exhibition hall stood the organization's most prized possession—the CODES Championship Trophy—displayed inside a secure glass showcase. The trophy represented years of hard work, innovation, and achievement.

At exactly 4:00 PM, the organizers gathered everyone for the closing ceremony. But when the curtain was lifted, the display case was empty.

The trophy had vanished.

There were no signs of forced entry. The glass case remained intact, the security alarms never activated, and no witness reported seeing anyone carrying the trophy out of the hall.

Someone had planned this carefully.

The event security team immediately locked all exits and began collecting every digital record available. Every person present at the event was identified, every important movement throughout the venue was logged, and all available communications and witness interviews were gathered into a central investigation database.

The database contains three categories of evidence:

- Information about every registered person at the event.
- Activity logs recording where people were seen and what they were doing throughout the day.
- Communications and evidence, including emails, witness statements, and forensic findings collected during the investigation.

Unfortunately, the lead investigator received an emergency call and had to leave before completing the case. Before leaving, they scribbled a few observations in their notebook.

Investigator's Notes

"This wasn't the work of an outsider."

"The thief blended in with everyone else."

"One person claimed to be in a different location than where the activity logs place them."

"Only a handful of people were recorded near the trophy shortly before it disappeared."

"Someone was seen carrying an object away from the exhibition area, but no one reported moving the trophy."

"An email mentioning 'moving the package before the ceremony' was deleted shortly after it was sent. The sender may not be guilty—but the recipient deserves attention."

"One piece of forensic evidence contradicts a witness statement."

"Several people appear suspicious when viewed individually, but only one person's records remain suspicious when all the evidence is connected."

"No single record reveals the truth."

"The answer only becomes clear when information from different parts of the database is combined."

The investigation team believes the database contains enough evidence to identify the thief. However, some people lied, some records are misleading, and several clues only make sense when different pieces of evidence are compared.

Your mission is to examine the evidence, eliminate innocent suspects, uncover contradictions, and identify the individual responsible for stealing the CODES Trophy.

Remember:

- Not every suspicious person is guilty.
- Not every clue is important on its own.
- The thief made mistakes—but only someone willing to connect the evidence will discover them.

The organizers are counting on your investigative skills.

Can you solve the mystery and recover the CODES Trophy?